PAMPATTIWAR, VIVEK DOB: 11/10/1969 (55 yo M) Acc No. 13717 DOS: 02/26/2025

Consultation Notes for VIVEK PAMPATTIWAR on 02/26/2025

History of Present Illness

Patient presented in our clinic today for follow up and to have scheduled EMG/NCS of LE electrophysiology test.
Patient reports worsening lower back pain and was unable to have his MRI or CT of lumbar image studies done due to insurance denial. Patient reports performing a medically directed home exercise program by his orthopedic doctor from January 1, 2024 until January 31, 2025. He states the exercise has not improved his pain and he now also has leg muscle spasms.
Vital Signs: Pain scale: 8 1-10 (VAS 8/10), BP: 152/92 mm Hg, HR: 90 /min, Wt: 118 lbs, Ht: 62 in.

Examination & Special Tests

Neuro: alert, oriented x 3. Motor and sensory grossly normal except mild decreased sensation in leg.
Spine: Tenderness at lumbar local region. Scooped posture and wide based gait with slight limping.
Special Tests: Positive Lumbar facet loading test, decreased ROM, Straight Leg Raise (SLR) positive for lumbar radiculopathy, Sciatic notch tenderness.

Clinical Assessments & Insurance Prior Authorization Denial Appeal

1. Muscle spasm - M62.838
2. Spondylosis without myelopathy or radiculopathy, lumbar region - M47.816
3. Idiopathic peripheral neuropathy - G60.9
4. Gait disturbance - R26.9
5. Spinal stenosis, lumbar region with neurogenic claudication - M48.062
6. Sacroiliac joint disease - M53.3
7. Chronic pain syndrome - G89.4
8. Paresthesia - R20.2

CLINICAL JUSTIFICATION & CONSERVATIVE THERAPY DOCUMENTATION:
Patient has moderate to severe lumbar spine pain with maximal VAS of 8/10, causing functional impairment in activities of daily living for past 3 months. Patient did not get relief with conservative management including NSAIDs, muscle relaxant, and medically directed home exercise program under PCP and orthopedic guidance for > 6 weeks.

DISAPPROVAL APPEAL STATEMENT:
Order for MRI of lumbar spine was denied by insurance company (Ambetter) for 'not having performing physical therapy for 6 weeks or medically-directed home exercise program'. This is an INAPPROPRIATE disapproval because patient has documented completion of a medically directed home exercise program by his orthopedic doctor everyday from January 1, 2024 to January 31, 2025 (13 consecutive months). Patient cannot tolerate further physical therapy due to severe pain and limited ROM.
Reorder: Imaging: MRI : Lumbar without contrast (CPT 72148)

Provider: Haiyan Wang, MD | Date: 02/26/2025
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